Claudius Buchanan,[26] a Scottish clergyman and a missionary, were extremely popular in both England and America. In fact, he must be credited with the corruption of the word ‘Jagannath’ to ‘juggernaut’ and for using the Rath Yatra to portray Hinduism as a ‘bloody, violent, superstitious and backward religious system’, which had to be rendered extinct and replaced with the gospel. He made the case for the ‘social reform’ of Bharat to his audience in England which resonated greatly owing to the popularity of Protestantism.

As the date for the renewal of the Company’s Charter in 1813 grew closer,[27] more efforts were invested by Buchanan and like-minded proponents to convince the British Parliament on the need for State support of Christian missionary efforts in Bharat. Buchanan managed to convince a sizeable section of the British public and lawmakers of the Company’s profiteering tendencies, which contrasted against the Christian philanthropy of the missionaries.[28] Both Houses of the British Parliament received hundreds of petitions from British Churches fervently appealing for the ‘propagation of Christian knowledge in India’.[29]

Circumstances were now ripe for William Wilberforce to once again make his proposal; on 19 February 1813,[30] he presented a Petition to the British Parliament from the Society in Scotland for propagating Christian knowledge, which read as follows:

> That the society was incorporated in the year 1709, by a charter from her majesty queen Anne, *for the farther promoting of Christian knowledge and increase of piety and virtue within Scotland, especially in the Highlands, Islands, and remote conners thereof, and for propagating the same in Popish and infidel parts of the world* [*sic*]*;* and that since that time, in consequence of the donations and bequests of pious and benevolent persons, the funds of the society have increased to a considerable amount, and have been faithfully applied to the purposes of the charter, agreeably to the will of the donors; and that the labours of the society, by means of their teachers, catechists, and missionaries, have, it is well known, been attended with great success in the education of youth, in furthering the interests of religion and virtue, and in diffusing, both in Scotland and America, the blessings of civilisation and industry, subordination to lawful authority, and attachment to the constitution and government of the British empire;